

ChatGPT Prompts for Bookkeepers & Accountants

25 Copy-Paste Templates | Client Emails · Financial Reports · Tax Season · Admin

 **FINANCIAL DATA SECURITY NOTICE (applies to ALL prompts in this pack):** Never input real client financial data into ChatGPT or any AI tool. This includes: Social Security Numbers (SSN), Employer Identification Numbers (EIN), full bank account numbers, full credit card numbers, payroll records, or any personally identifiable financial information.

Always use placeholders throughout every prompt:

- SSN → [SSN XXX-XX-XXXX]
- EIN → [Client EIN]
- Bank account → [Account Ending in XXXX]
- Client name → [Client Name] or a fictional alias
- Dollar amounts → use approximate or rounded figures where possible

Review and verify all AI-generated output before sending to clients or filing with any government agency. Final professional judgment remains with the licensed bookkeeper or accountant.

CATEGORY 1 — Client Communication (7 Prompts)

Prompt 1 — Overdue Invoice Follow-Up (ONE-SHOT: All 3 Stages)

You are a professional bookkeeper writing collection emails for an overdue invoice.

Client details:

- Client Name: [Client Name]
- Invoice Number: [Invoice #]
- Invoice Amount: \$[Amount]
- Due Date: [Due Date]
- Days Overdue: [Number] days
- Service Provided: [Brief description, e.g., "monthly bookkeeping for March"]
- My Business Name: [Your Business Name]

Write all THREE follow-up emails at once, separated by dividers. Use the exact tone described for each stage.

EMAIL 1 — Gentle Reminder (Days 1-7 overdue)

Tone: Warm, assume it slipped through. Offer easy ways to pay. No guilt.

EMAIL 2 — Firm Follow-Up (Days 8-21 overdue)

Tone: Direct and professional. Reference that Email 1 was sent. State a clear deadline. Mention late fee policy if applicable: [Late fee policy, e.g., "1.5% per month" or "none"].

EMAIL 3 — Final Notice (Days 22+ overdue)

Tone: Serious and formal. State this is the final notice before collections or service suspension. Keep it factual, not emotional.

Format each email with: Subject line, greeting, body paragraphs, and sign-off.

My email signature: [Your Name, Title, Phone, Website]

Prompt 2 — New Client Welcome Email

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a warm but professional welcome email for a new client who just signed on.

Details:

- Client Name: [Client Name / Business Name]
- Services they signed up for: [e.g., monthly bookkeeping, payroll, tax prep]
- First meeting or onboarding date: [Date or "TBD"]
- Documents they need to send: [e.g., last 3 bank statements, prior year tax return, chart of accounts]
- My Business Name: [Your Business Name]
- My Name & Title: [Your Name, e.g., Jane Smith, Certified Bookkeeper]

Write a welcome email that:

1. Expresses genuine enthusiasm about working together
2. Clearly lists what they need to send and by when
3. Explains what happens next (e.g., onboarding call, first deliverable timeline)
4. Reassures them they made a good choice

Subject line + full email body. Professional but personable tone.

Prompt 3 — Rate Increase Announcement Email

You are a professional bookkeeper who needs to notify a long-term client of a service rate increase.

Details:

- Client Name: [Client Name]
- Current monthly rate: \$[Current Rate]
- New monthly rate: \$[New Rate]
- Effective date: [Date, e.g., "September 1, 2025"]
- Reason (choose one or combine): [Cost of living / expanded service scope / market rate adjustment / software cost increase]
- How long they've been a client: [e.g., "2 years" or "since January 2023"]
- Anything staying the same: [e.g., "service level, turnaround time, dedicated support"]
- My Name & Business: [Your Name, Your Business Name]

Write a rate increase email that:

1. Opens with appreciation for their loyalty
2. Announces the new rate and effective date clearly
3. Briefly explains the reason without over-apologizing
4. Reinforces the value they're receiving
5. Invites them to reach out with questions

Tone: Confident, appreciative, not defensive. Subject line + full email.

Prompt 4 — Service Expansion Proposal Email

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write an email proposing an additional service to an existing client who currently only uses [Current Service].

Details:

- Client Name: [Client Name / Business Name]
- Current service: [e.g., monthly bookkeeping]
- New service to propose: [e.g., quarterly tax planning, payroll management, accounts receivable cleanup]
- Why this client would benefit: [e.g., "their AR is aging over 60 days" / "tax season is approaching" / "they're hiring employees soon"]
- Proposed add-on price: \$[Amount] per [month/quarter/project]
- My Name & Business: [Your Name, Your Business Name]

Write a proposal email that:

1. Opens with a specific observation about their business (use the benefit reason above)
2. Introduces the service and what it includes
3. States the price clearly
4. Ends with a low-pressure call to action (e.g., "happy to chat for 15 minutes if you'd like to learn more")

Tone: Consultative, helpful – not salesy. Subject line + full email.

Prompt 5 — Year-End Tax Document Request Email

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a year-end email to a client requesting the documents needed for tax preparation.

Details:

- Client Name: [Client Name / Business Name]
- Tax year: [e.g., 2024]
- Document deadline (when you need them by): [Date]
- List of documents needed: [e.g., all bank statements, PayPal/Stripe reports, mileage log, home office measurements, 1099s received, any large equipment purchases]
- Filing deadline reminder: [e.g., "April 15, 2025" or "March 15 for S-Corps"]
- My Name & Business: [Your Name, Your Business Name]

Write an email that:

1. Opens with a friendly year-end greeting
2. Clearly lists each document needed (use a numbered or bulleted list)
3. States the deadline and explains why it matters
4. Makes it easy to respond (e.g., "reply to this email or upload to [your portal]")
5. Offers to answer questions

Subject line + full email. Friendly but organized tone.

Prompt 6 — Client Referral Request Email

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a warm referral request email to send to a satisfied client.

Details:

- Client Name: [Client Name]
- How long they've been a client: [e.g., "18 months"]
- Recent win or specific compliment (if any): [e.g., "we just finished their cleanest tax season yet" or leave blank]
- What kind of referral you're looking for: [e.g., "other small business owners, freelancers, or e-commerce sellers in the \$200K-\$1M revenue range"]
- Incentive (if any): [e.g., "one month free" / "no incentive, just asking"]
- My Name & Business: [Your Name, Your Business Name]

Write a referral email that:

1. Opens by acknowledging the relationship and a recent positive moment
2. Explains you're looking to grow and asks if they know anyone who might benefit
3. Describes the ideal referral in one sentence
4. Makes the ask feel easy and no-pressure
5. Thanks them in advance

Subject line + full email. Personal, genuine tone – not a form letter.

Prompt 7 — Scope of Services Confirmation Email

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a scope-of-services confirmation email to send at the start of an engagement or after a scope discussion.

Details:

- Client Name: [Client Name / Business Name]
- Services included: [List each service, e.g., "monthly bank reconciliation, accounts payable entry, monthly P&L and balance sheet, year-end 1099 preparation"]
- Services NOT included (out of scope): [e.g., "tax filing, payroll, sales tax returns"]
- Monthly fee: \$[Amount]
- Billing date: [e.g., "1st of each month"]
- Deliverable schedule: [e.g., "reports delivered by the 10th of the following month"]
- Communication method: [e.g., "email only / scheduled monthly calls"]
- My Name & Business: [Your Name, Your Business Name]

Write a confirmation email that:

1. Summarizes what is included in plain language
2. Clearly states what is out of scope (this prevents disputes later)
3. States the fee and billing terms
4. Sets expectations for turnaround and communication
5. Invites them to confirm they've read and agree by replying

Subject line + full email. Professional, clear, zero ambiguity.

Prompt 8 — Monthly P&L Summary Email

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a monthly Profit & Loss summary email to send to a small business client.

Details:

- Client Business Name: [Business Name]
- Month & Year: [e.g., March 2025]
- Total Revenue: \$[Amount]
- Total Expenses: \$[Amount]
- Net Profit (or Loss): \$[Amount]
- Top 3 expense categories: [e.g., "Payroll \$8,200 / Software \$1,100 / Advertising \$900"]
- Notable change from last month (if any): [e.g., "revenue up 12%" / "utilities spiked due to rate increase" / "no major changes"]
- One action item or observation: [e.g., "consider reviewing the software subscriptions line" or "strong month – on track for Q2 goal"]

Write a P&L summary email that:

1. Opens with the headline numbers in plain English (not accounting jargon)
2. Highlights the top expense categories
3. Notes any significant changes and gives a brief reason if known
4. Ends with one clear observation or recommendation
5. Keeps total length to 200–300 words

Subject line + full email. Plain language, no jargon – write as if explaining to a business owner, not an accountant.

Prompt 9 — Cash Flow Statement Plain-Language Narrative

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a plain-language narrative explaining a client's cash flow statement for a given period.

Details:

- Client Business Name: [Business Name]
- Period: [e.g., Q1 2025 or Month of April 2025]
- Operating Activities Net Cash: \$[Amount] (positive = cash in, negative = cash out)
- Key drivers of operating cash flow: [e.g., "strong collections on AR" / "large vendor payments due" / "seasonal slowdown in sales"]
- Investing Activities Net Cash: \$[Amount]
- Details: [e.g., "purchased \$12,000 equipment" or "none"]
- Financing Activities Net Cash: \$[Amount]
- Details: [e.g., "owner drew \$5,000" or "none"]
- Ending Cash Balance: \$[Amount]
- Context/concern (if any): [e.g., "cash is lower than last quarter but receivables are healthy" or "none"]

Write a 200-300 word narrative that:

1. Opens with the ending cash position and whether it's healthy given the business context
2. Explains operating cash flow in plain terms (what drove cash in/out from day-to-day operations)
3. Briefly covers investing and financing if there's activity
4. Ends with a one-sentence forward-looking note

Audience: A small business owner who does not read financial statements regularly. Zero accounting jargon.

Prompt 10 — Budget vs. Actual Variance Explanation

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a brief variance analysis narrative to explain the difference between budgeted and actual numbers for a client.

Details:

- Client Business Name: [Business Name]
- Period: [e.g., June 2025]
- Revenue – Budgeted: \$[Amount] | Actual: \$[Amount] | Variance: \$[+/- Amount]
- Total Expenses – Budgeted: \$[Amount] | Actual: \$[Amount] | Variance: \$[+/- Amount]
- Net Profit – Budgeted: \$[Amount] | Actual: \$[Amount] | Variance: \$[+/- Amount]
- Biggest positive variance and reason: [e.g., "marketing came in \$2,000 under budget because the planned ad campaign was delayed"]
- Biggest negative variance and reason: [e.g., "payroll was \$3,500 over budget due to overtime during the product launch"]
- Overall assessment: [e.g., "on track" / "slightly behind" / "ahead of plan"]

Write a 200–250 word variance narrative that:

1. Opens with the overall assessment in one sentence
2. Explains the two to three most significant variances (positive and negative) in plain terms
3. Attributes each variance to a specific, understandable cause
4. Ends with a forward-looking statement (what to watch next month)

Plain language, no accounting jargon. Format as a short memo or email-ready paragraph block.

Prompt 11 — Accounts Receivable Aging Summary

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write an AR aging summary message to help a business owner understand their outstanding receivables situation.

Details:

- Client Business Name: [Business Name]
- Report Date: [Date]
- Current (0-30 days): \$[Amount] – [Number] invoices
- 31-60 days: \$[Amount] – [Number] invoices
- 61-90 days: \$[Amount] – [Number] invoices
- 90+ days: \$[Amount] – [Number] invoices
- Total AR Outstanding: \$[Amount]
- Largest single overdue account (if comfortable sharing): [Client name or "Client A"] – \$[Amount]
- [Days] days overdue
- Recommended action: [e.g., "send final notice to 90+ accounts" / "schedule a call with Client A" / "consider collections for 90+ accounts over \$500"]

Write a clear summary that:

1. Opens with the total outstanding and what percentage is current vs. overdue
2. Calls out the 61-90 and 90+ buckets specifically (these are the risk zones)
3. Names the largest overdue account (use alias if needed) and recommends a specific action
4. Ends with a suggested next step the business owner can take today

Tone: Direct, helpful, not alarming. 150-200 words. Format as a short report or email.

Prompt 12 — Year-End Financial Health Summary Letter

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a year-end financial health summary letter to send to a small business client.

Details:

- Client Business Name: [Business Name]
- Tax Year: [e.g., 2024]
- Total Annual Revenue: \$[Amount]
- Total Annual Expenses: \$[Amount]
- Net Profit: \$[Amount] | Net Profit Margin: [%]
- Revenue change vs. prior year: [e.g., "+18%" or "-5%"]
- Top 3 expense categories for the year: [List with amounts]
- Biggest financial win this year: [e.g., "reduced software costs by \$4,200" / "collected on two long-overdue accounts"]
- One area to improve next year: [e.g., "Q1 cash flow is consistently tight – consider a line of credit"]
- One tax planning note: [e.g., "Q4 equipment purchase saved approximately \$X in taxes" or "consider maxing out SEP-IRA before April 15"]

Write a year-end letter (300-400 words) that:

1. Opens with an overall assessment of the year
2. Highlights the key financial metrics in plain terms
3. Celebrates the biggest win
4. Honestly names one area to work on in the coming year
5. Closes with a forward-looking, encouraging tone

Professional but warm. Not just numbers – tell the story of their year.

Prompt 13 — Payroll Summary Explanation

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a payroll summary email to send to a business owner after processing payroll.

Details:

- Business Name: [Business Name]
- Payroll Period: [e.g., "May 16-31, 2025"]
- Pay Date: [Date]
- Number of Employees: [Number]
- Gross Payroll: \$[Amount]
- Total Employer Taxes (FICA, FUTA, SUTA): \$[Amount]
- Total Payroll Cost (gross + employer taxes + any benefits): \$[Amount]
- Any notable items: [e.g., "one employee hit the FUTA wage base – employer FUTA will drop next period" / "two PTO payouts included" / "nothing unusual"]
- Next payroll date: [Date]

Write a payroll summary email that:

1. Confirms payroll was processed and the pay date
2. States gross payroll, employer tax burden, and total cost clearly
3. Explains any notable items in plain language
4. States the next payroll date

Keep it under 200 words. Clear, professional, no jargon. Format as a short confirmation email with subject line.

Prompt 14 — Quarterly Review Meeting Agenda

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a quarterly financial review meeting agenda to send to a small business client before your meeting.

Details:

- Client Business Name: [Business Name]
- Quarter Being Reviewed: [e.g., Q2 2025 (April-June)]
- Meeting Date & Time: [Date and Time]
- Meeting Format: [In-person / Video call / Phone]
- Key topics to cover: [e.g., "Q2 P&L review, cash flow concerns, upcoming tax estimates, Q3 budget discussion"]
- Any specific issue to address: [e.g., "payroll costs spiked in June – want to walk through why" or "none"]
- Estimated meeting length: [e.g., 45 minutes]

Write a meeting agenda that includes:

1. A brief intro confirming the meeting details
2. Numbered agenda items with estimated time for each
3. A section for the client to add their own questions or topics
4. Any documents they should review or bring

Format as a professional email with the agenda embedded.

Tone: Organized, collaborative, and easy to read at a glance.

CATEGORY 3 — Tax & Compliance (6 Prompts)

Prompt 15 — Tax Deduction Explanation by Industry

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a plain-language explanation of common tax deductions for a client in a specific industry.

Details:

- Client Business Type: [e.g., freelance graphic designer / restaurant owner / real estate agent / e-commerce seller / contractor]
- Business Structure: [e.g., Sole Proprietor / LLC / S-Corp]
- Top deductions to explain: [List 5-8 specific deductions relevant to their industry, e.g., "home office, vehicle mileage, software subscriptions, professional development, client meals"]
- Any deductions they've missed in prior years (if known): [e.g., "they've never tracked mileage" or "none"]
- My Name & Business: [Your Name, Your Business Name]

Write a clear explanation that:

1. Lists each deduction with a one-paragraph explanation of what qualifies, what documentation is needed, and a rough example of tax savings
2. Flags any commonly missed deductions for their industry
3. Includes a brief note on record-keeping best practices
4. Ends with a reminder that this is general guidance and they should confirm specifics with their tax preparer

Tone: Educational, helpful, not overwhelming. Write for someone who is not a numbers person.

Prompt 16 — Tax Season Preparation Checklist Email

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a tax season preparation email with a checklist to send to all clients at the start of tax season.

Details:

- Tax Year: [e.g., 2024]
- Document submission deadline (your internal deadline): [Date]
- Tax filing deadline: [e.g., April 15, 2025]
- Method for document submission: [e.g., "upload to our secure portal at [link]" / "email directly to [email]" / "drop off at office"]
- Standard documents every client needs: [e.g., all 2024 bank statements, all 1099s received, mileage log, home office sq ft, major purchases over \$500]
- Anything new this year to flag: [e.g., "new 1099-K rules if you received payments via PayPal/Venmo/CashApp" or "none"]
- My Name & Business: [Your Name, Your Business Name]

Write an email with:

1. A brief intro explaining it's time to start gathering tax documents
2. A clean, numbered or bulleted checklist of required documents
3. Any new rule or change to flag this year
4. Clear instructions on how and where to submit documents
5. Your deadline and the official filing deadline
6. A friendly closing with your contact information

Subject line + full email. Clear, organized, scannable.

Prompt 17 — IRS Notice Response Guidance Email

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write an email to a client who has received an IRS notice, to help them understand what it means and what to do next.

Details:

- Client Name: [Client Name]
- IRS Notice Type/Number: [e.g., CP2000 / CP501 / CP503 / Letter 525 / other: describe briefly]
- What the notice says (summarize): [e.g., "IRS says there's a discrepancy between reported income and 1099s on file" / "balance due notice for \$X"]
- Amount in question (if any): \$[Amount or "N/A"]
- Likely cause (if known): [e.g., "unreported 1099 income" / "estimated tax payment not credited" / "identity verification needed" / "unknown"]
- Urgency level: [Response deadline date, or "no immediate deadline"]
- Recommended next step: [e.g., "do not ignore – respond by [date]" / "we will review and respond on your behalf" / "likely requires CPA involvement"]
- My Name & Business: [Your Name, Your Business Name]

Write a client email that:

1. Opens by reassuring the client that IRS notices are common and does not mean they're in trouble (unless it genuinely is serious)
2. Explains in plain English what the notice means
3. States the recommended next step clearly
4. Sets expectations for timeline and who handles what
5. Ends with your contact info for questions

Tone: Calm, reassuring, clear. Avoid creating panic. Subject line + full email.

Prompt 18 — Quarterly Estimated Tax Reminder

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a quarterly estimated tax reminder email to send to self-employed clients or business owners.

Details:

- Client Name (or use "Dear [Client]" for a general template): [Client Name or leave as variable]
- Tax quarter and due date: [e.g., "Q2 2025 – due June 16, 2025"]
- Estimated payment amount (if calculated): \$[Amount] or "see your estimated tax worksheet attached"
- Payment method options: [e.g., "IRS Direct Pay at irs.gov/payments, EFTPS, or check payable to U.S. Treasury"]
- State estimated tax due (if applicable): [State name + amount, or "N/A"]
- Penalty note: [Include brief note about underpayment penalty, or "skip"]
- My Name & Business: [Your Name, Your Business Name]

Write a reminder email that:

1. Opens with the deadline date prominently stated
2. States the federal payment amount and how to pay
3. Includes state payment reminder if applicable
4. Briefly explains what happens if they miss it (penalty – not scary, just factual)
5. Offers to answer questions

Subject line + full email. Short and action-oriented – this should take them less than 2 minutes to read and act on.

Prompt 19 — Audit Preparation Checklist

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write an audit preparation guide and checklist to share with a client who has been notified of an IRS audit.

Details:

- Client Business Name: [Business Name]
- Audit type: [e.g., correspondence audit (by mail) / office audit / field audit]
- Tax year(s) under audit: [e.g., 2022 and 2023]
- Items being questioned (if known): [e.g., "home office deduction, vehicle expenses, Schedule C income" or "unknown – general review"]
- Response deadline or audit date: [Date]
- Who will handle the audit: [e.g., "I will handle correspondence on your behalf" / "you will need a CPA or tax attorney" / "we will prepare documents together"]

Write a guide that includes:

1. A brief intro reassuring the client and explaining the type of audit
2. A numbered checklist of documents they need to locate and organize (specific to the items being questioned)
3. General best practices for audit preparation (e.g., don't provide more than asked, keep records organized by year)
4. Clear statement of who does what and by when
5. Contact info for questions

Tone: Calm, organized, professional. This is stressful for the client – be reassuring while being thorough.

Prompt 20 — New Employee Financial Onboarding Guide

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a financial onboarding email/guide to send to a business owner who is hiring their first employee (or first few employees).

Details:

- Business Owner Name: [Name]
- Business Name: [Business Name]
- State of Business: [State]
- Employee start date: [Date or "upcoming"]
- Topics to cover: [Select all that apply: payroll setup / W-4 and I-9 forms / payroll taxes and deadlines / workers' comp / state withholding registration / payroll software options]
- Payroll software they're using or considering: [e.g., "Gusto" / "QuickBooks Payroll" / "ADP" / "undecided"]
- My Name & Business: [Your Name, Your Business Name]

Write an onboarding guide email that:

1. Congratulates them on their hire and sets the tone as "this is manageable – I'll guide you"
2. Lists the immediate action items before the employee starts (W-4, I-9, payroll account setup)
3. Explains employer payroll tax obligations in plain language (FICA match, FUTA, state requirements)
4. Covers payroll deposit schedules (monthly vs. semi-weekly)
5. Recommends payroll software based on what they've shared
6. States your role going forward (what you handle vs. what they handle)

Subject line + full email. Thorough but not overwhelming. Write as if this is their first time.

CATEGORY 4 — Business Operations & Admin (5 Prompts)

Prompt 21 — Bank Reconciliation Discrepancy Explanation Note

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a brief client-facing note explaining a bank reconciliation discrepancy and how it was resolved (or what needs to happen next).

Details:

- Client Business Name: [Business Name]
- Month Being Reconciled: [e.g., May 2025]
- Discrepancy found: \$[Amount] difference between bank statement and books
- Cause of discrepancy: [e.g., "outstanding check #1042 dated May 28 had not cleared" / "a \$450 bank fee was not entered in the books" / "duplicate entry found for vendor payment" / "cause unknown – needs client clarification"]
- Resolution: [e.g., "resolved – outstanding check cleared in June" / "corrected – fee entered and books reconciled" / "client needs to provide receipt for transaction on May 14"]
- Books now reconcile: [Yes / No – pending client action]

Write a short note (100-150 words) that:

1. States the reconciliation period and that a discrepancy was found
2. Explains the cause in plain terms (no jargon)
3. States whether it's been resolved or what the client needs to do
4. Keeps a reassuring, matter-of-fact tone

Format as a brief internal memo or email note. Do not make the client feel like something is wrong with their business.

Prompt 22 — Accounting Software Upgrade Proposal

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a proposal email recommending an accounting software upgrade or change for a client.

Details:

- Client Business Name: [Business Name]
- Current software: [e.g., "spreadsheets" / "QuickBooks Desktop" / "Wave" / "FreshBooks"]
- Recommended software: [e.g., "QuickBooks Online" / "Xero" / "Zoho Books"]
- Main reason for recommendation: [e.g., "their current spreadsheet setup can't scale with their growth" / "bank feeds will automate 70% of data entry" / "real-time reporting will save 3+ hours/month in reconciliation"]
- Estimated cost of new software: \$[Amount]/month
- Migration complexity: [Low / Medium – explain briefly, e.g., "can migrate historical data in 1-2 hours"]
- My role in migration: [e.g., "I will handle the full migration" / "I'll guide you through setup"]

Write a proposal email that:

1. Opens by identifying the specific pain point the current software creates
2. Recommends the specific software and explains why it's the right fit
3. Estimates cost and migration effort honestly
4. States your role clearly
5. Ends with a soft call to action (e.g., "let me know if you'd like to schedule 20 minutes to walk through it")

Tone: Advisory, not pushy. This is a recommendation, not a sales pitch. Subject line + full email.

Prompt 23 — Chart of Accounts Plain-Language Explainer

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a plain-language explanation of the Chart of Accounts for a new client who has never seen one before.

Details:

- Client Business Name: [Business Name]
- Business type: [e.g., service-based / product-based / both]
- Accounting software being used: [e.g., QuickBooks Online / Xero / other]
- Their biggest area of confusion (if known): [e.g., "they don't know the difference between an expense account and a liability" / "they've been miscategorizing income" / "general overview needed"]

Write an explanation that:

1. Starts with what a Chart of Accounts IS in one sentence (in plain English, not textbook definition)
2. Explains the 5 main account types (Assets, Liabilities, Equity, Income, Expenses) with a real-world example for each using their specific business type
3. Explains why getting categories right matters for their taxes and business decisions
4. Gives 2-3 common miscategorization mistakes to avoid
5. Ends with a reassurance that you manage this for them and they don't need to memorize it

Tone: Educational, friendly, patient. Imagine explaining this to someone who runs a great business but has never taken an accounting class.

Prompt 24 — Financial Goal-Setting Session Follow-Up Email

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a follow-up email after a financial goal-setting session with a client.

Details:

- Client Name: [Client Name / Business Name]
- Session Date: [Date]
- Goals discussed and agreed upon: [List 2-4 goals, e.g., "reach \$300K in annual revenue / reduce monthly expenses by \$1,500 / build a 3-month cash reserve / prepare to hire first employee by Q3"]
- Key action items for the client: [e.g., "review software subscriptions by end of month" / "open a separate savings account for tax reserves"]
- Key action items for you (bookkeeper): [e.g., "set up monthly budget tracking" / "create a dashboard showing revenue vs. goal"]
- Next check-in: [e.g., "quarterly review scheduled for September 15"]
- My Name & Business: [Your Name, Your Business Name]

Write a follow-up email that:

1. Thanks them for their time and acknowledges the session was productive
2. Clearly summarizes the goals agreed upon
3. Lists action items for each party (client and bookkeeper)
4. States the next check-in date
5. Ends with an encouraging, forward-looking note

Subject line + full email. Energetic but professional – they should feel motivated after reading this.

Prompt 25 — Post-Audit Results Summary Email

You are a professional bookkeeper. Write a post-audit summary email to send to a client after an IRS or state audit has concluded.

Details:

- Client Business Name: [Business Name]
- Audit type: [e.g., IRS correspondence audit / state sales tax audit / payroll audit]
- Tax year(s) audited: [Year(s)]
- Outcome: [Choose: "no change" / "minor adjustment – client owes \$X" / "refund issued – \$X" / "penalty assessed – \$X, payment plan arranged"]
- Items examined: [e.g., "home office deduction, vehicle expenses"]
- What happened with disputed items: [e.g., "home office accepted with documentation / vehicle deduction reduced by 20% due to insufficient mileage log"]
- Next steps for the client: [e.g., "no action needed" / "pay \$X by [date] via IRS Direct Pay" / "begin keeping a mileage log going forward"]
- My Name & Business: [Your Name, Your Business Name]

Write a post-audit email that:

1. Opens with the headline result (resolved – here's what happened)
2. Summarizes what was examined and the outcome for each item
3. States clearly what the client needs to do (or that no action is needed)
4. Includes one forward-looking lesson to prevent the same issue next audit
5. Closes with a reassuring, confident tone

Subject line + full email. The client has been through a stressful process – close it out with clarity and calm.